

Let's Talk About Mental Health

Converse RSE

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Looking after your **mental health** is important. But it is also important to talk about it; to smash the stigma and create an environment where people can talk openly, especially in the workplace.

1 in 4 adults will experience a mental health problem each year in England. ^[1]

41% of long-term absences are due to poor mental health. ^[2]

Poor mental health results in **millions of lost working days**, costing UK employers **billions of pounds** each year. ^[3]

It is clear we need to do more, but it can be difficult to know who to talk to and what support is available.

[1] - mind.org.uk [2] - CIPD [3] - MHFA England



If You Are Struggling

1. Talk to your **line manager**.
2. Talk to a **Mental Health First Aider**, who can direct you to additional help and support.
3. Your institution may have an **Employee Assistance Programme**, providing free, confidential counselling and support. Their **Occupational Health** service can also provide support in the workplace.
4. Talk to your **doctor**; they can prescribe medication to help manage your condition or refer you to other specialist services.
5. A wide range of different forms of **counselling** and **therapy** is available through the NHS or privately.

SAMARITANS

Need to talk?

Call Samaritans on 116 123.



More Information

We recommend checking out:

- **Mind** in England and Wales
- **SAMH** in Scotland
- **Action Mental Health** in Northern Ireland.



Talking to your colleagues or line manager can be particularly daunting. There is still a lot of stigma surrounding mental health in our society, especially in the workplace.

However, it is in everyone's best interests if employees are more open and employers create an environment where people feel able to speak up. It is usually easier - and cheaper! - to address an issue before it becomes a serious problem than it is to fix it afterwards.



The ConverseRSE Project

The **ConverseRSE** project aims to continue the conversation around mental health in the research software community, as well as provide information and resources to help people get support when they need it.

The **ConverseRSE** website is an online hub for mental health information and support for Research Software Engineers and other Research Technical Professionals. The site includes tips for looking after yourself, your colleagues and your team, as well as links to a variety of other resources, including downloadable posters and this leaflet.

Visit the
ConverseRSE site



"It's better to raise a **RED FLAG**
before you're forced to wave a
WHITE ONE."

Contributing to ConverseRSE

We need your help to improve the **ConverseRSE** site and maximise the impact of the project:

- **Share your Story:** We're asking for blog posts on a variety of topics. Have you experienced a mental health issue? How do you manage it? Sharing our stories helps people feel seen, realise they're not alone and can encourage them to get support before they need it.
- **Share resources:** Tell us about any **projects, communities** or **resources** that you think will be relevant to others in the community.
- **Contribute to the website:** help us boost content, accessibility and impact.

Submit a
blog post

